



The Humanitas Institute

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Runnels Academy

School Website: <https://www.runnelsacademy.org/>

December 22, 2025

Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix for more details.

ACCS Member School

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools ACCS or the Society for Classical Learning SCL is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Executive Summary

Runnels Academy TX 79720 presents a robust CLASSICAL Christian educational model across all six rubric categories. Public-facing materials consistently foreground a biblical, theologically grounded curriculum centered on the Trivium (grammar, logic, rhetoric), Great Books, Latin/Greek, and a Christ-centered worldview. The school communicates formation of character and virtue as central aims, emphasizes rigorous classical content, and embeds active parental partnership within a community oriented around shared faith and governance. Evidence from the school's site repeatedly ties academics to theology, virtue, and a Christian worldview, with explicit statements about a Bible-centered curriculum, a Great Books emphasis, and a deliberate, formation-focused philosophy. While liturgical practices are not heavily foregrounded in public materials, the integration of faith with learning, the Great Conversation, and parental partnership are consistently stressed.

Overall rating by category: - Religious and Metaphysical Foundations: CLASSICAL - Purpose and Goal: CLASSICAL - Curriculum: CLASSICAL - Pedagogy: CLASSICAL - Faculty: CLASSICAL - Parents & Community: CLASSICAL

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL - Evidence: Explicit statement of faith, biblical worldview, and theology at the center of education; Christ-centered mission; statement of faith detailing core beliefs. - Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Strong presence of positive religious/theological keywords (Bible, God, theology, biblical worldview, Christ-centered, Gospel). No clear negative indicators in public materials. - Why this rating: The school's materials foreground transcendental religious aims, theological grounding, and communal worship-oriented culture through faith-centered statements.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL - Evidence: Mission to form virtuous, wise students; aim to shape culture through wise and victorious Christian living; emphasis on formation, not merely information; pursuit of truth and beauty as real. - Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive indicators include formation, virtue, truth, beauty, and a unified teleology around human flourishing under a Christian worldview. Limited negative signals in public materials. - Why this rating: The purpose centers on formation, virtue, and the cultivation of truth and beauty as real, aligning strongly with classical aims.

Element 3: School Curriculum — CLASSICAL - Evidence: Explicit description of the Trivium (grammar, logic, rhetoric); emphasis on primary sources in history; Great Books/Great Conversation; Latin; Greek; Story of the World as history text; integration of classical arts and languages. - Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Strong presence of positive curriculum keywords (grammar, logic, rhetoric, Great Books, Trivium, Latin, Greek, history with primary sources). Minimal or no negative signals in public content. - Why this rating: Curriculum aligns closely with liberal arts core elements and the Great Conversation framework central to classical education.

Element 4: School Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — CLASSICAL - Evidence: Lower school activities include singing, memorization, and recitation; upper school includes Socratic discussion, debates, formal logic, and rhetoric; songs and memory work highlighted; hands-on projects; field trips; presentations. - Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive pedagogical keywords include recitation, memorization, Socratic

dialogue, debate, logic, rhetoric, and living-books approaches. Some notes of contemplative/restful pedagogy are present in formation emphasis, with a blend of restfulness and rigor. - Why this rating: Pedagogy reflects a described progression from memory-based, contemplative lower-forms to dialectic, rhetoric-based upper-forms consistent with classical practice.

Element 5: School Faculty — CLASSICAL - Evidence: Emphasis on model teachers and mentors, the living curriculum, a professional community; parent-school partnership; statements about faculty as core to the school; portraits of teacher standards and expectations. - Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive indicators include living curriculum, model teachers, mentorship, and professional, godly conduct. The materials stress the role of faculty as anchors of the school's ethos. - Why this rating: The faculty framing emphasizes virtue, mentorship, and the faculty's central role in delivering formation, aligning with classical expectations.

Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL - Evidence: Explicit statement that parents are primary in education; emphasis on parental partnership, co-teaching role, and active parent involvement; invitation to visits; materials about family involvement in admissions and school life. - Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive indicators include "parents are primary," "parents as co-teachers," involvement in admissions, and open invitations for community engagement; low or no negative signals detected. - Why this rating: The institution positions parents as essential partners in a classical education and promotes active parental involvement and learning opportunities for families.

What Would Move the Needle

- If any category were NOT CLASSICAL or SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL, concrete steps would include expanding explicit liturgical practices in public materials, increasing explicit articulation of virtuous formation in measurable terms, or showcasing more explicit evidence of Socratic pedagogy across grade levels. Since all six categories are CLASSICAL, there are no substantial needle-moving changes required based on the current public materials.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

By reading or using this document, you acknowledge and accept the limitations described above.